IIM KOZHIKODE®
LIVE
LABORATORY FOR INNOVATION VENTURING AND ENTREPRENEURSHIP

IIMK LIVE

BPP Interim Report (EPGP-17)

Group No.: B2

Section: B

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Executive Summary:

InvestIQ is a social financial engagement platform that transforms learning about financial markets into an interactive, community-driven experience. Rather than functioning as an investment simulation platform, the product enables users to connect, compete, and showcase their financial knowledge through portfolio-based challenges with friends, family, colleagues, and a wider community.

Users can create private leagues or participate without any entry fee in daily, weekly, and monthly contests by building virtual portfolios of market equities. At the end of each contest, participants are ranked and rewarded non-cash prizes based on the relative performance of their portfolio selections (measured as per real data which would be gained from other publicly available sources, for which users will also be guided in the form of redirecting links on our platform), creating an engaging environment where users test their market understanding, compare strategies, and earn social recognition through leaderboards, achievement streaks, virtual rewards, and seasonal rankings. The platform's core value proposition is to make financial markets social, engaging, and accessible. AI-powered post-contest insights help users understand the strengths and weaknesses of their portfolio choices, while curated masterclasses, learning content, and partnerships with financial education providers, brokerages, and fintech platforms encourage continuous learning and responsible market participation. By combining social interaction, friendly competition, gamification, and personalized insights, the platform aims to foster financial confidence and create an ecosystem where users learn together, compete together, and grow together.

<table>
<tr><th colspan="5">Business Plan Canvas</th></tr>
<tr><th>Key Partnerships</th><th>Key Activities</th><th>Value Prepositions</th><th>Customer Relationships</th><th>Customer Segments</th></tr>
<tr><td rowspan="2">• Discount Brokerages (Zerodha, Groww, Angel One)

• Universities & Student Finance Clubs

• Finfluencers & Content Creators

• AMCs & Financial Brands

• Educational/Public Market Data Providers</td><td>• Platform & App Development

• AI Prompting & Insight Analytics

• B2B Institutional Sales

• Campus Ambassador & Community Management</td><td rowspan="2">• For Users: Risk-free, social financial learning; AI portfolio diagnostics; gamified competition & career rewards.

• For Colleges/Corporates: Turnkey financial literacy & employee engagement tool.

• For Brokerages: High-intent Demat user acquisition funnel.</td><td>• Automated AI-driven feedback

• Community-led social loops & private leagues

• Self-service freemium app experience</td><td rowspan="2">• B2C Students: Gen-Z (18–22) seeking practical market knowledge.

• B2C Professionals: Early earners (23–30) wanting strategy benchmarking.

• B2B: Universities, MBA institutes, and Corporate HRs.</td></tr>
<tr><td>Key Resources
• Proprietary AI Analytics Engine

• Platform User Network & Social Graphs

• Gamification Engine & Leaderboard Logic</td><td>Channels
• iOS & Android Mobile App

• Campus Ambassador Network

• Social Viral Loops (WhatsApp, LinkedIn, IG Cards)</td></tr>
<tr><th colspan="3">Cost Structure</th><th colspan="2">Revenue Streams</th></tr>
<tr><td colspan="3">• Fixed: Engineering & Team Payroll, Base Cloud Infrastructure, Legal & Compliance, Office/Admin.

• Variable: AI LLM API Processing, Scaled Cloud Bandwidth, Marketing/CAC, Payment Gateway Fees (2%), Non-Cash Rewards.</td><td colspan="2">• B2C Subscriptions: Monthly Subscription for Premium features

• B2B Licenses: Tiered rate structure.

• Brokerage Affiliates: CPA referral fees per Demat activation.

• Brand Sponsorships: Sponsored challenges & co-branded leagues.</td></tr>
</table>

Industry Analysis and Market:

InvestIQ is operating at the intersection of the following industries:

- FinTech
- EdTech
- Fantasy Gaming
- Retail Investing

Macro Market Trends:

Growth of Retail Investing in India –

- According to reports published by NSDL (National Securities Depository Limited) and Central Depository Services Limited (CDSL) and SEBI, India has approximately 185 million demat accounts in 2024 which was only 40 million in the year 2020 which reflects a growth of almost 4x within 5 years
- Retail participation in stock markets have significantly increased post Covid according to SEBI Investor Survey 2025
- SIP Participation in mutual funds is at record high. The monthly SIP inflows are around 31000 crores recently published by various financial firms.
- The Indian mutual fund industry's Assets Under Management (AUM) increased from approximately 22.26 lakh crores in FY20 to 65.74 lakh crores in FY25 which shows it has almost tripled in the last 5 years.
- Tier 2 and Tier 3 cities are contributing to this retail investing growth. New SIP registrations in B30 cities have increased from **202 lakh to 274 lakh registrations** within a year. Thematic MF sales have increased from **30,140 crores in FY24 to 68,827 crores in FY25** which is almost a growth of **128%.**

Reasons for this – Digital onboarding has become very easy, UPI ecosystem has matured, there are a lot of discount broker platforms, financial influencers and content creators have increased massively, disposable income among youth has increased significantly and increased aspiration for wealth creation.

Growth of Fantasy Gaming in India

- India's fantasy sports market is estimated to have a market size of **Rs. 34000 crores** by joint research conducted by Deloitte and Federation of Indian Fantasy sports.
- This industry serves more than **13 crore (130 million +) registered users**.
- India has the largest fantasy player market globally
- This industry has generated a revenue of **26,700 crore in FY24**

- It is projected to reach **49,500 crores by FY29**, which is a growth at **13% CAGR**

Growth of FinTech in India

- India's fintech market is projected to reach approximately **USD 150–200 billion in revenue opportunity by 2030** according to BCG reports
- India has one of the highest fintech adoption rates at approximately **87%**, significantly above the **global average which is 62%**
- UPI processed over **100+ billion annual transactions**, transforming digital financial behaviour across the country.

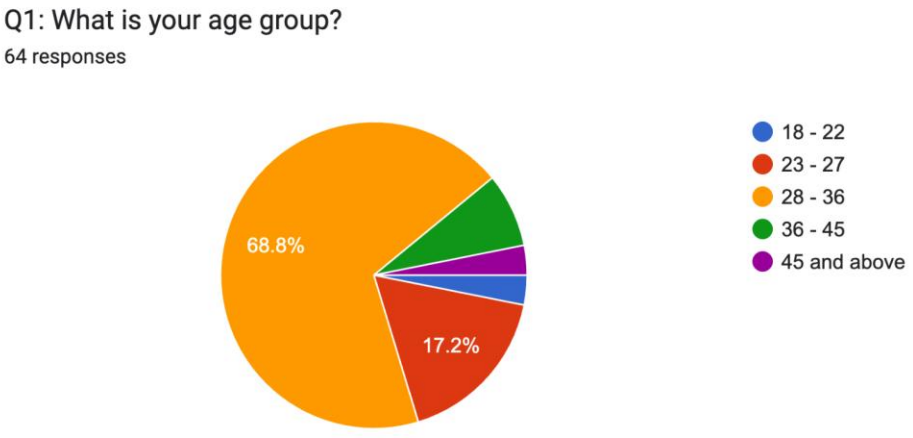
Primary Market Research

Overview and Methodology

A structured questionnaire was circulated to gather primary evidence on how prospective users think about investing, learning, gamification and willingness to pay, in order to validate and refine the InvestIQ business proposal. The survey was administered on Google Forms and generated 64 valid responses. Questions covered five themes: respondent profile, financial knowledge and barriers, social or gamification behaviour, platform feature preferences, and business model.

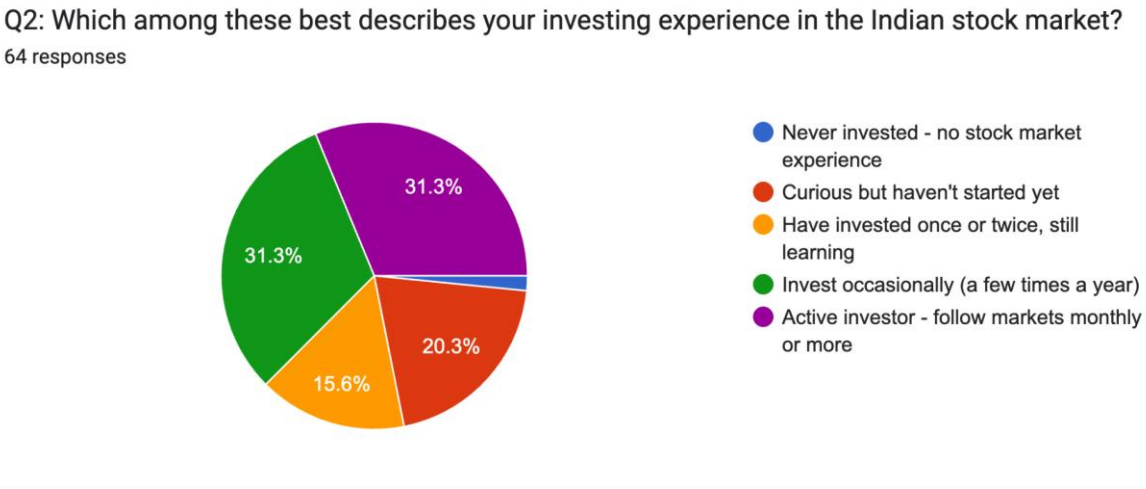
Respondents Profile

Age skews towards established, working-age professionals, not very young adults: 68.8% of respondents are 28–36 years old, 17.2% are 23–27, 7.8% are 36–45, and 3.1% each fall in the 18–22 and 45-and-above bands.

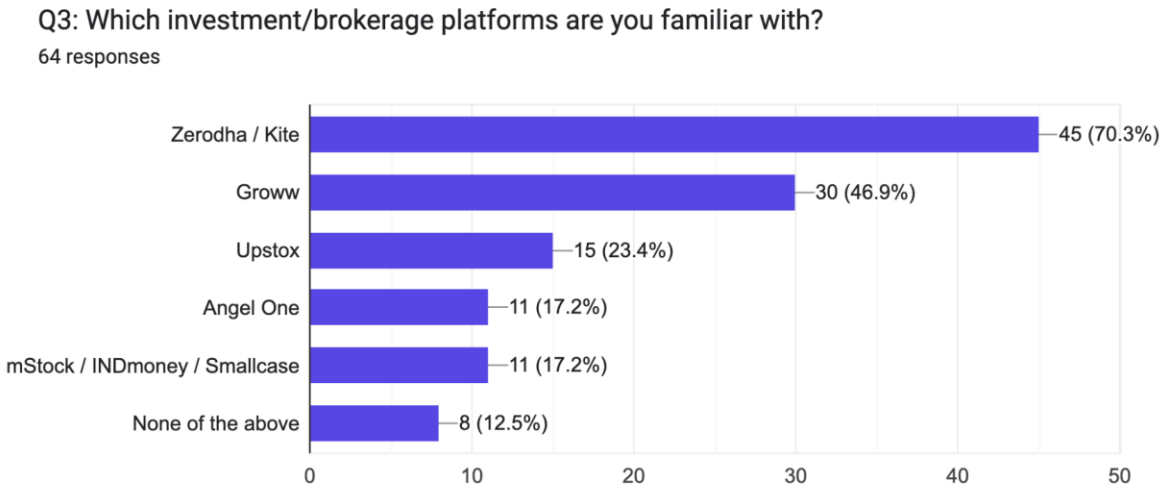


Investing experience is more advanced than a purely novice audience: 31.2% are active investors who follow markets monthly or more, and a further 31.2% invest occasionally (a few times a year) — together 62.4% already

invest with some regularity. 20.3% are curious but haven't started, 15.6% have invested once or twice and are still learning, and only 1.6% have never invested at all.



Brokerage familiarity is high across the board — Zerodha/Kite (70.3%) and Groww (46.9%) dominate awareness, followed by Upstox (23.4%), Angel One and mStock/INDmoney/Smallcase (17.2% each). Only 12.5% recognised none of the listed platforms.



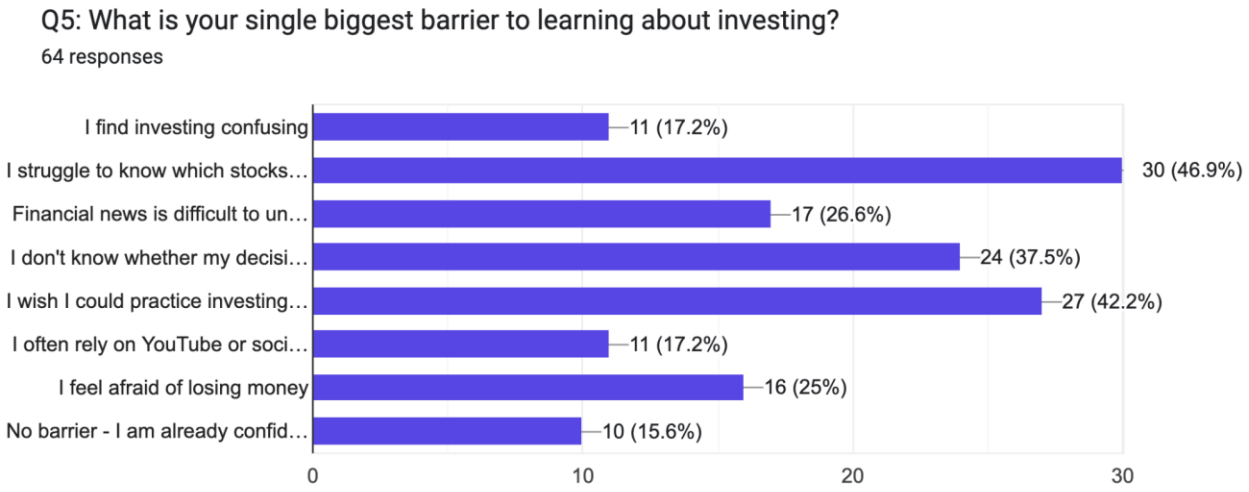
Financial Knowledge, Confidence and Barriers

Confidence clusters at the mid-point — 45.3% rate themselves a 3/5, and only 7.8% rate themselves a 5/5. Notably, this holds even though most respondents already invest with some regularity. This means the confidence gap is not purely a beginner problem, it persists even among people already active in the market, reinforcing demand for a low-stakes way to test and validate decisions.

Rating	1	2	3	4	5
% of respondents	3.1%	14.1%	45.3%	29.7%	7.8%

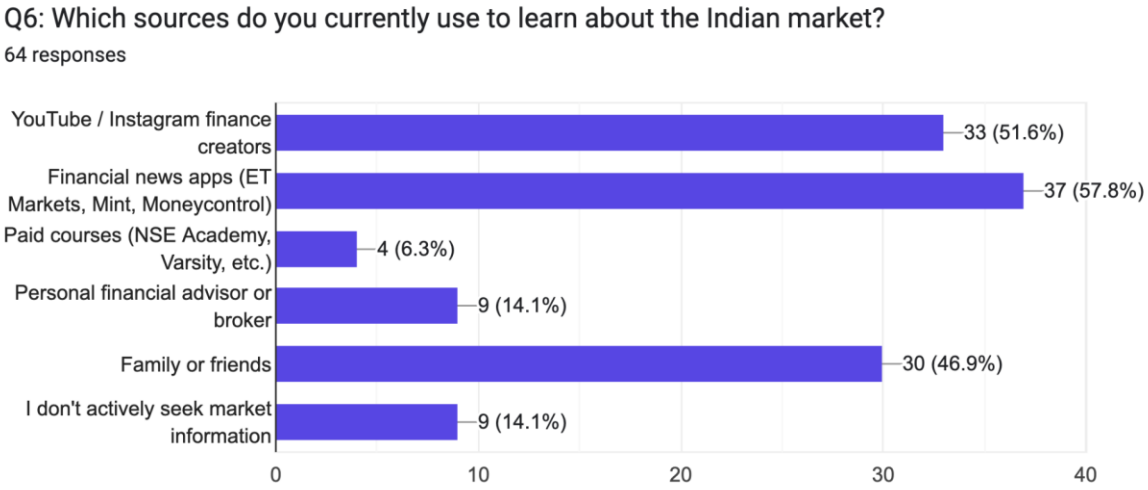
Biggest barriers to learning

The largest single barriers map directly onto InvestIQ's core mechanic — a simulated portfolio with feedback — rather than onto pure content/education gaps.



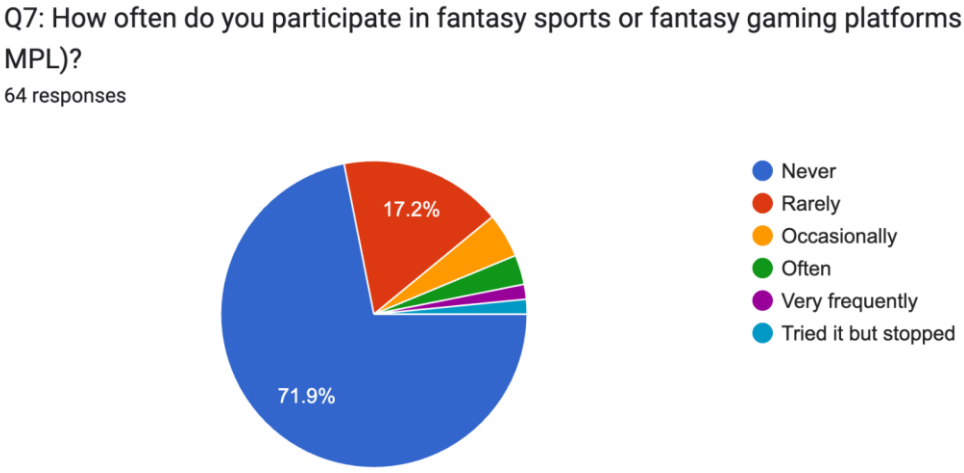
Current learning sources

Learning today is informal and unstructured (news apps, creators, word-of-mouth); formal paid education is barely used. This supports positioning InvestIQ as a structured-but-informal alternative rather than competing head-on with paid courses.

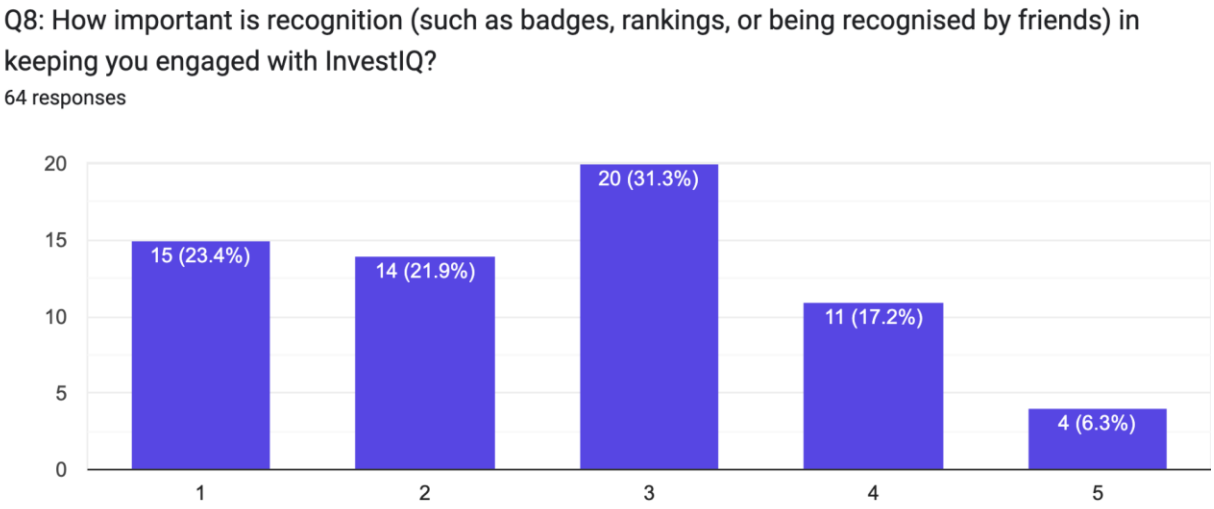


Social and Gamification Behaviour

Prior exposure to fantasy gaming is actually low: 71.9% of respondents have never participated in a fantasy sports/gaming platform (e.g. Dream11, MPL), 17.2% rarely have, and only about 11% fall into occasional-or-heavier use. InvestIQ cannot assume its audience already understands fantasy-league mechanics.



Recognition and social status (badges, rankings, leaderboards) are only moderately motivating on a 1–5 importance scale, responses skew toward the lower-mid range (23.4% rated it a 1, 21.9% a 2, 31.2% a 3), with just 6.2% rating it a 5.



As most users are new to fantasy-format products, not returning fantasy-sports players, InvestIQ's onboarding needs to actively teach the contest/leaderboard mechanic rather than assume familiarity. Combined with the

moderate importance placed on recognition, social/competitive features need to be positioned as a secondary engagement layer introduced after the core practice-and-learn loop, not as the headline hook.

Platform Feature Ratings

Respondents rated 9 proposed features on a 1–5 appeal scale. Average scores confirm the pattern above: functional, feedback-oriented features clearly outrank social/competitive ones.

Feature	**Avg. rating (out of 5)**
Portfolio score & performance tracking	4.19
Personalized learning & beginner-friendly lessons	4.02
Simulated real-world market events	3.92
AI feedback on your investment decisions	3.89
Practice investing with virtual money	3.69
Daily quizzes to improve financial knowledge	3.69
Free investment challenges & competitions	3.67
Rankings, badges & achievement rewards	3.30
Compete with friends / join private groups	3.08

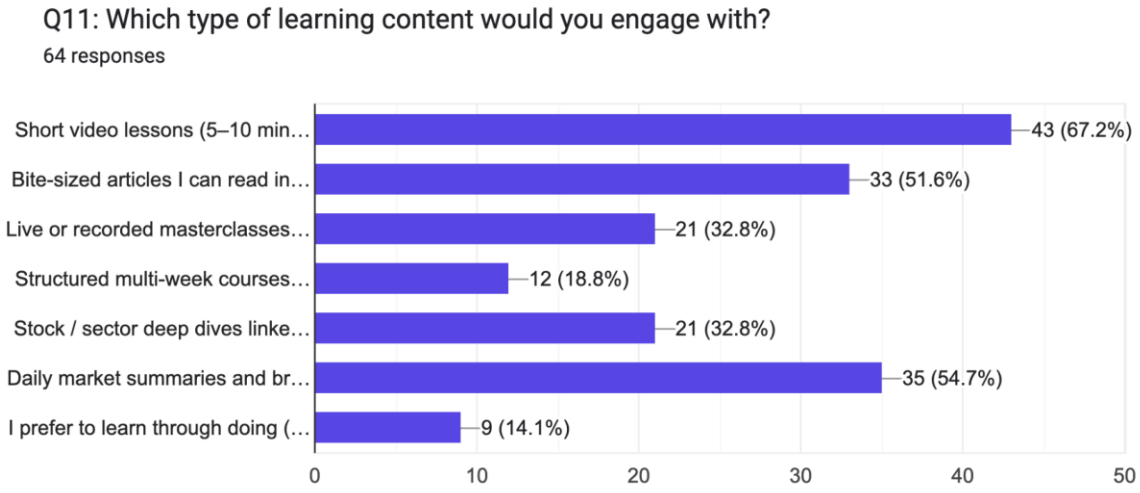
The two lowest-rated features in the entire survey are both social/competitive directly corroborating the finding that gamification should support, not lead, the core product experience.

AI and Learning Content Preferences

Insight type	**% selecting**
Understand why my portfolio performed well or poorly	75.0%
Learn about important market trends/news	73.4%
See how my choices compared with top performers	54.7%
Read simple explanations about the stocks chosen	42.2%
Recommended articles/videos/learning resources	35.9%
Get a short quiz or learning tip	31.2%
Wouldn't use AI insights	6.2%

This is the strongest single validation in the dataset for the "AI-Driven Tailored Learning" differentiator: 3 in 4 respondents want explainable, portfolio-linked feedback not generic tips. This is a design cue for the AI product roadmap.

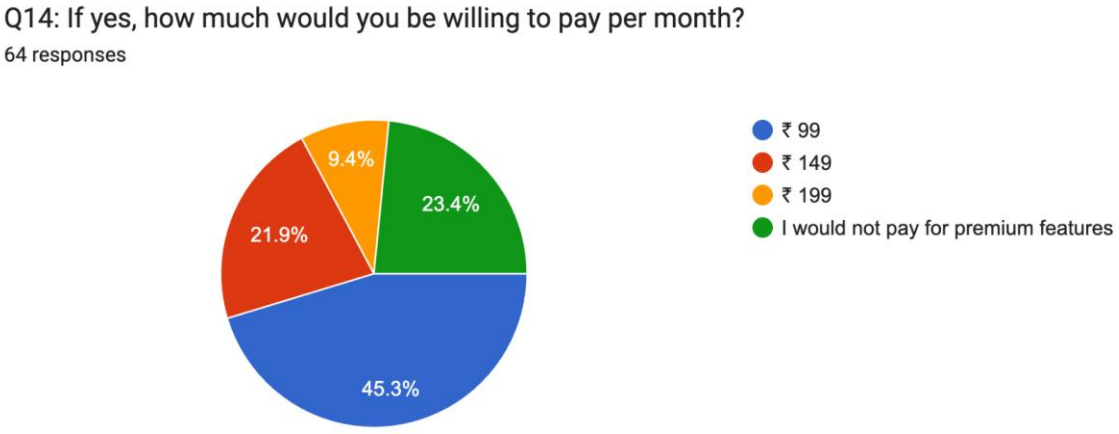
Content strategy should favour short, snackable, daily-cadence formats over long-form courses. This is reinforced further by open-ended requests for daily/pre-market video summaries and end-of-day recaps.



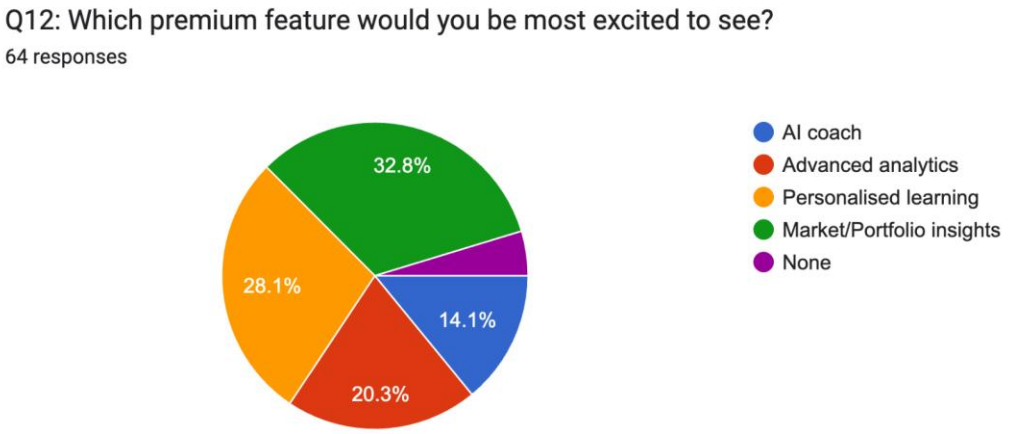
Willingness to Pay and Business Model Signals

Only 14.1% are a hard "no." The large majority (56.2%) are conditionally willing to pay depending on feature value, and a further 17.2% would pay if priced affordably and together, roughly 86% are open to paying under the right conditions. This is a considerably more monetizable audience than a simple "most won't pay" framing would suggest; the real question is which features justify the price, not whether people will pay at all.

₹99/month is the clear preferred price point (45.3%), well ahead of ₹149 (21.9%) and ₹199 (9.4%) — a strong steer toward an entry price at or near ₹99 rather than a higher anchor.

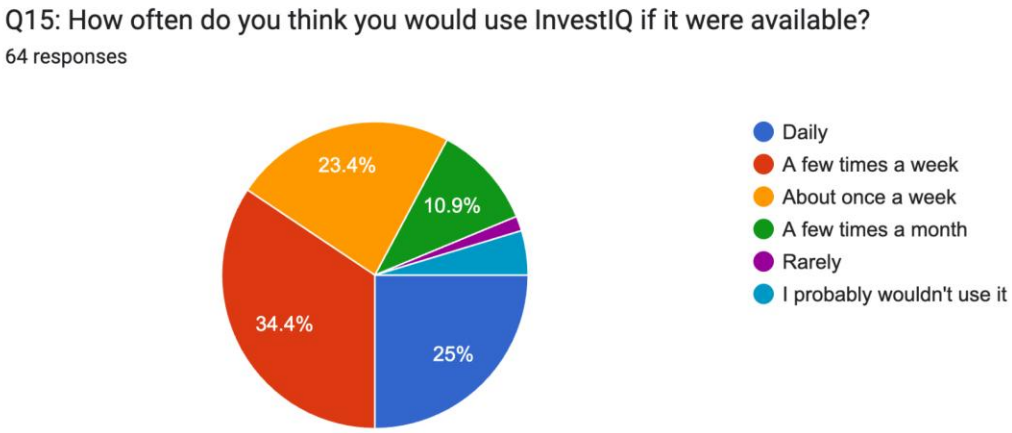


The premium feature that most were excited about was the market / portfolio insights with personalized learning coming in on a close second.



Expected Usage Frequency

Nearly 60% of respondents expect to use InvestIQ multiple times a week or daily and a meaningfully higher engagement expectation than a casual, once-a-week product. Combined with earlier sections, this supports designing for habit formation (daily contests, streaks, daily AI recaps) with an entry price point at or near ₹99/month, while still offering a genuinely useful free tier to convert the ~37.5% pre-active/beginner segment identified in an earlier section as well.



Recurring Themes from Open-Ended Feedback

- "Skin in the game": several respondents felt gamification alone won't build real investing discipline unless there is some financial or reputational stake (e.g. small real-money stakes, or penalties for not following one's own stated strategy).
- Daily market content: repeated requests for short daily/pre-market videos, end-of-day recaps, and instant alerts on RBI/SEBI/government announcements relevant to a user's own watchlist.
- Deeper personalisation: interest in risk-profile-based basket suggestions, tax-bracket-aware stock suggestions, and annualised-return/opportunity-cost comparisons against other asset classes.
- Community layer: interest in an interactive space to discuss insights and learnings with other users, beyond a simple leaderboard.
- Real-world reward tie-in: a few respondents wanted top performers to receive tangible rewards tied to real portfolio performance, not just in-app recognition.

Summary and takeaways

- Segment reality check: the respondent base skews toward already-active, 28–36-year-old professionals (62.4% invest with some regularity), not pure beginners under 28. Validate the persona and TAM sizing against this before finalising GTM targeting.
- Confidence gap persists even among active investors — practice-and-feedback is a need across the experience spectrum, not just for absolute beginners.
- AI differentiator validated most strongly of all features tested (75% want portfolio-linked "why" explanations) — prioritise this over generic recommendation engines.
- Gamification should stay secondary to learning utility and cannot assume prior familiarity. Most respondents have never used a fantasy sports app, and the two lowest-rated features overall are both social/competitive.
- Content should be short-form and daily-cadence, not structured multi-week courses.
- Monetization looks more promising than a surface read suggests only 14.1% are a hard no, ₹99/month is the clear preferred entry price, and expected usage skews toward multiple-times-a-week or daily. This supports a freemium funnel with a habit-forming paid tier priced near ₹99.
- Open-ended feedback flags a genuine design tension — "real stakes" vs. "risk-free learning" — that should be explicitly addressed in the compliance/regulatory workstream (game of skill vs. chance) already planned for the next reporting period.

Competitive Analysis

The team enhanced and validated the primary business concept. They clarified that InvestIQ is a gamified investment simulation tool designed to educate individuals about finance and facilitate their engagement in the actual market. We enhanced the problem-solution fit by leveraging primary user insights and secondary research. This demonstrated that novice investors seek an enjoyable, risk-free environment for learning.

Secondly, the team employed Porter's Diamond framework to comprehensively analyse India's competitive landscape. The investigation identified strong factor circumstances, marked by a substantial market base and sophisticated digital infrastructure, coupled with dynamic demand conditions fuelled by behaviourally inclined fantasy game consumers, and a supportive ecosystem of fintech and gaming platforms.

Third, the team conducted extensive comparative benchmarking by comparing InvestIQ to Dream11's Dream Street and other simulation platforms. This enabled us to identify a distinct strategic deficiency: the existing platforms lack organized financial education. This rendered AI-driven tailored learning a more significant method for differentiation.

Fourth, the team employed the Hambrick & Fredrickson Strategy Diamond to ensure coherence among all elements. We identified essential components such as arenas, cars, and differentiators, and we discovered deficiencies in staging and economic rationale that clarified the most critical jobs.

Ultimately, the team proposed strategic recommendations and a staged growth plan encompassing user acquisition, development of AI competencies, and establishment of partnerships.

The investigation determined that InvestIQ possesses a strong market position for leadership in India. The nation possesses robust digital infrastructure, a substantial user base eager to learn, and a distinct demand for gamified financial education.

Product Details

MVP App Link: https://investiq-play-learn.lovable.app/

The Core Value Proposition

InvestIQ is a gamified financial-learning platform where users build virtual investment portfolios, compete in time-bound challenges against friends, classmates, and colleagues, and receive AI-generated feedback that explains the reasoning behind their results. It sits deliberately in the gap between three inadequate options: dense financial courses that few people finish, real-money trading apps that ask beginners to risk capital before they understand risk, and fantasy or gaming apps that offer competition with no financial substance at all. InvestIQ combines the practice of the first, the excitement of the second, and the stickiness of the third — while

remaining, by design, a subscription education product rather than a trading, advisory, or money-gaming platform.

Primary Users

InvestIQ's primary audience is young, tech-savvy adults in their late teens through mid-twenties students and early-career professionals who are curious about investing but have never practiced it. They consume finance content on YouTube, Instagram, and LinkedIn, are comfortable with mobile-first products, and already spend time in competitive, gamified experiences such as fantasy sports. What they lack is not interest but a safe, structured, socially engaging way to convert that interest into practical skill. That gap is what InvestIQ is built to close.

Customer Persona

Overview

To ensure that InvestIQ is designed around the needs of its target audience, a representative user persona was developed based on research into young adults who are interested in investing but lack practical experience. This persona helps guide product decisions by keeping the user's goals, motivations, and pain points at the centre of the design process.

Primary Persona – Rahul Sharma

Basic Information

Attribute	**Details**
Name	Rahul Sharma
Age	24 Years
Occupation	Final-Year Engineering Student
Location	Bangalore, India
Education	Bachelor's Degree in Computer Science
Investment Experience	Beginner (0–1 year)
Technical Proficiency	High
Preferred Device	Smartphone

Persona Summary

Rahul is a technology-savvy engineering student who has recently developed an interest in personal finance and investing. He regularly consumes financial content on YouTube, Instagram, and LinkedIn but finds traditional investing platforms intimidating due to their complexity and the risk of losing real money.

He prefers learning through practical experiences rather than reading lengthy educational material. Rahul enjoys competitive environments, participates in fantasy sports, and is motivated by rewards, achievements, and peer recognition.

Goals

- Learn investing in a practical and engaging way.
- Build confidence before investing real money.
- Understand portfolio diversification and risk management.
- Compete with friends and improve investment skills.
- Earn rewards while learning.
- Develop long-term financial literacy.

Pain Points

- Does not know where to begin learning about investing.
- Finds financial terminology difficult to understand.
- Is afraid of losing money while experimenting.
- Traditional learning resources are lengthy and difficult to follow.
- Lacks practical experience in building investment portfolios.
- Receives conflicting advice from different online sources.

Motivations

- Achieving financial independence.
- Learning through hands-on experience.
- Friendly competition with peers.
- Earning rewards and recognition.
- Improving decision-making skills.
- Tracking personal progress over time.

Behaviours

- Uses mobile applications daily.

- Watches finance-related videos and social media content.
- Participates in online competitions and gamified platforms.
- Prefers short, interactive learning experiences over traditional courses.
- Regularly tracks personal performance and achievements.

Preferred Features in InvestIQ

- Fantasy investment contests.
- AI-powered portfolio feedback.
- Beginner-friendly learning modules.
- Portfolio Builder with virtual money.
- XP, badges, and rewards.
- Leaderboards and community discussions.



User Journey Map

Purpose

The User Journey Map illustrates the complete experience of a new user interacting with InvestIQ—from discovering the platform to continuously learning, participating in contests, and redeeming rewards. It highlights the user's actions, emotions, pain points, and the opportunities where InvestIQ adds value.

Stage	User Actions	User Thoughts	Pain Points	InvestIQ Opportunity
1. Discover	Finds InvestIQ through social media, college events, referrals, or advertisements.	"This looks like an interesting way to learn about investing."	Investing seems complicated and risky.	Position InvestIQ as a fun, risk-free learning platform using virtual money.
2. Sign Up	Creates an account using Email or Google Sign-In.	"I hope getting started is quick and easy."	Long registration processes discourage new users.	Offer frictionless signup with Google OAuth and minimal form fields.
3. Onboarding	Completes a personalized onboarding questionnaire.	"The app is trying to understand my investing experience."	Beginners may not know where to start.	Personalize recommendations based on experience, goals, and risk profile.
4. Dashboard	Explores the dashboard and views contests, learning modules, rewards, and community features.	"Everything I need is available in one place."	Users may feel overwhelmed by too much information.	Provide a clean dashboard with clear navigation and prioritized content.
5. Join/Create Contest	Joins a public contest or creates a private contest with friends.	"Competing with friends makes learning more exciting."	Users may not understand contest rules initially.	Provide simple contest setup, tooltips, and beginner-friendly contests.

6. Build Portfolio	Selects stocks and allocates virtual capital using quantity or percentage weights.	"I can experiment without risking real money."	Users may struggle with portfolio diversification.	Offer AI suggestions, diversification score, and real-time portfolio guidance.
7. Contest Participation	Tracks portfolio performance during the contest.	"I want to see how my decisions compare with others."	Waiting for contest results may reduce engagement.	Show rankings, portfolio updates, and progress indicators during contests.
8. AI Insights	Reviews AI-generated performance analysis after contest completion.	"Now I understand why my portfolio performed the way it did."	Users often don't learn from mistakes.	Provide personalized AI coaching, diversification analysis, and improvement recommendations.
9. Rewards	Earns InvestIQ Coins and redeems them for rewards.	"My learning is being rewarded."	Gamification without meaningful rewards loses appeal.	Offer gift cards, merchandise, premium features, and achievement badges.
10. Continuous Engagement	Completes learning modules, joins new contests, interacts with the community, and climbs the leaderboard.	"I'm improving every week and enjoying the journey."	Users may lose motivation over time.	Maintain engagement through daily streaks, challenges, leaderboards, XP, and new rewards.

User Flow Diagram

The User Flow Diagram illustrates the navigation path that a user follows while interacting with InvestIQ. The journey begins with user acquisition through the landing page, followed by authentication and personalized onboarding. After completing onboarding, users are directed to a centralized dashboard that acts as the primary navigation hub.

From the dashboard, users can access the platform's core features, including contest participation, portfolio creation, AI-powered investment insights, community interactions, and the rewards marketplace. The flow emphasizes seamless navigation with minimal friction, allowing users to transition between learning and competition effortlessly.

The platform is designed around a continuous engagement cycle. Users participate in contests, receive AI-generated feedback on their investment decisions, earn XP and InvestIQ Coins based on their performance, redeem rewards, and return to participate in additional contests or learning modules. This cyclical flow supports sustained user engagement while progressively improving financial literacy.



Value Proposition Canvas

Customer Jobs & Pains	InvestIQ Pain Relievers	Customer Gains Created
Wants to learn investing practically rather than through lengthy theory	Learn-by-doing investment challenges using virtual capital and real market instruments in a simulated environment	Develops practical portfolio management skills and investment confidence before investing real money
Afraid of losing money while experimenting with investments	Completely risk-free environment with zero real-money exposure; all rewards are non-cash and funded by the platform or sponsors	Can experiment freely, test different strategies, and learn from mistakes without financial loss
Finds financial terminology, market concepts, and online advice confusing or contradictory	AI-powered post-contest insights that explain portfolio performance and market movements in simple, easy-to-understand language without giving investment recommendations	Gains clear, unbiased understanding of investment concepts and the reasoning behind successful and unsuccessful decisions
Lacks motivation to continue learning through traditional financial education methods	Gamified experience featuring contests, leaderboards, badges, streaks, achievements, and social recognition	Learning becomes enjoyable, competitive, and engaging, resulting in higher retention and continuous participation
Wants to measure progress and continuously improve investment decision-making skills	Personalized behavioural analytics, performance dashboards, and adaptive learning paths based on user strengths and weaknesses	Sees measurable improvement over time, develops better financial judgement, and builds long-term investing confidence

Architecture

The Information Architecture (IA) defines how the features, content, and navigation of InvestIQ are organized to create an intuitive and scalable user experience. Since InvestIQ combines financial learning, portfolio simulation, contests, AI coaching, gamification, and social engagement, the architecture is designed around a hub-and-spoke model, where the Dashboard serves as the central navigation hub connecting users to all major modules.

The architecture prioritizes discoverability, minimizes navigation complexity, and ensures users can easily move between learning, practicing, competing, and reviewing their performance.

Information Architecture Principles

The design of InvestIQ is guided by the following principles:

- User-Centric Navigation: Frequently used features such as contests, portfolio management, and AI insights are accessible directly from the dashboard.
- Progressive Disclosure: Information is revealed gradually to avoid overwhelming new users while still providing advanced functionality for experienced learners.
- Logical Grouping: Features with similar objectives are grouped together, such as learning modules, rewards, and community interactions.
- Consistency: Navigation patterns, layouts, and interaction styles remain consistent across all screens.
- Scalability: The architecture supports the future addition of investment instruments, educational content, AI capabilities, and gamification features without restructuring the application.



Primary Navigation Structure

The application is divided into ten primary modules, each serving a distinct purpose within the learning journey.

Module	Purpose
Dashboard	Central hub providing portfolio overview, contests, learning progress, rewards, and personalized recommendations.
Contests	Browse, join, create, and manage fantasy investment contests.
Portfolio Builder	Build virtual investment portfolios using quantity-based or weight-based allocation methods.
AI Insights	View AI-generated portfolio analysis, diversification scores, benchmark comparisons, and personalized recommendations.
Learning	Access structured courses, quizzes, videos, and educational content to improve financial literacy.
Community	Engage with other learners through discussions, polls, market ideas, and social interactions.
Rewards	Earn and redeem InvestIQ Coins, unlock badges, and track achievement progress.
Leaderboards	Compare performance across contests and track rankings among friends and global users.
Profile	Manage personal information, achievements, contest history, and learning progress.
Settings	Configure notifications, privacy, security, language, and application preferences.

Operations

Challenge Operations

Challenge Type	Duration	Format	Reward Tier
Daily Challenge	24 hours	Single-stock or themed mini-portfolio pick against a benchmark; solo or friend group	XP + streak credit + daily badge
Weekly Competition	7 days	Full simulated portfolio management within rules set (e.g., sector cap, max 8 holdings)	XP, leaderboard rank, weekly badge
Monthly Event	1 month	Themed challenge (e.g., "Dividend Month", "Volatility Month") with a curated learning path attached	Rare badge + profile flair + certificate
Seasonal League	1 quarter	Multi-round tournament with promotion/relegation tiers (Bronze → Diamond)	Season trophy, leaderboard hall-of-fame, exclusive avatar items

Challenge Lifecycle

Design — Product + Content define rules, constraints, learning objective

↓

Schedule — pushed to Challenge Orchestration Engine with start/end timestamps

↓

Enrolment — users opt in via app; virtual capital ring-fenced for the challenge

↓

Live tracking — real-time (delayed 15-min feed for cost control) portfolio valuation

↓

Lock & settle — positions frozen at challenge close; final valuation computed

↓

Score & rank — risk-adjusted score computed; leaderboard published

↓

AI feedback + rewards — insight generated, badges/XP issued, results shared to community feed

Score Calculation

Score = a blend of absolute simulated return, risk-adjusted return (Sharpe-style ratio using simulated volatility), and a diversification/rule-adherence factor, never raw return alone, so the leaderboard does not implicitly reward reckless risk-taking. The exact weighting is published in-app so users understand what "good investing" is being scored on.

Leaderboard Updates

- Daily challenges: leaderboard refreshes on a 15-minute delayed cycle during market hours, finalises at market close.
- Weekly/monthly/seasonal: nightly batch recompute; final settlement locked at challenge end to prevent late manipulation.
- Anti-gaming checks (Data & Analytics + AI Trust & Safety) run before any leaderboard is marked final.

Badge Allocation & Reward System

- Rule-based badges (e.g., "5-day streak", "First Challenge Completed") — deterministic, instant issuance.
- Percentile badges (e.g., "Top 10% this week") — computed at settlement, batch-issued.
- Milestone badges (e.g., "100 Lessons Completed") — triggered off the learning-progress ledger.
- • All rewards are explicitly non-cash (XP, badges, streaks, cosmetic profile items, leaderboard rank) — this is a compliance-critical design constant, restated in every reward-facing UI string.

Community Operations

Community Type	Formation	Moderation Model
Friend Groups	Invite-link based, capped at 50 members	Self-moderated + AI content filter
College Leagues	Verified via campus email domain, run via Community/Marketing partnership	Campus ambassador + AI filter + escalation to central team
Corporate Leagues	Provisioned under a B2B contract, admin console for HR/L&D	Corporate admin + central Trust & Safety
Public Communities	Open, topic-based (e.g., "Mutual Funds 101")	AI moderation first pass + human review queue

Moderation & Reporting Workflow

AI content classifier scans posts/comments in real time (spam, abuse, unlicensed advisory language)

↓

Flagged content auto-hidden pending review if confidence is high; queued for review if borderline

↓

User-reported content enters the same queue with priority weighting

↓

Human moderator reviews within SLA, action taken (restore / remove / warn / suspend)

↓

Repeat-offender tracking feeds an account-level trust score used across Support and Community

A dedicated, standing content rule bans any user post that gives specific buy/sell/hold advice or promises returns — this is enforced by the same AI classifier used for abuse detection (see Part 2), since unlicensed advisory content in the community layer is the platform's single largest regulatory exposure.

AI Integration

AI is designed throughout this platform as a learning engine, not a decision engine. Every feature below is bound by one non-negotiable guardrail, enforced at both the prompt/system level and via a separate output classifier: no AI-generated content may recommend buying, selling, or holding a specific security, or promise a return. This is treated as a compliance control, not a style preference.

Portfolio Performance Explanation

Attribute	Detail
Purpose	Explain ‘why’ a simulated portfolio moved the way it did, in plain language, after the fact.
Inputs	Portfolio holdings, market data deltas, challenge rules
AI Model / Process	Templated analytics engine + LLM narrative layer, constrained to descriptive (never prescriptive) language
Outputs	Post-challenge explanation: "Your portfolio rose 2.1%, driven mainly by X; here's the concept that explains it"
User Benefit	Understands cause and effect, not just outcome
Business Benefit	Core differentiator vs. plain leaderboard apps
Release Stage	MVP

Behavioural Finance Analysis

Attribute	Detail
Purpose	Detect behavioural patterns (overtrading, recency bias, herding into trending picks) in a user's decisions.

Inputs	Trade/allocation timestamps and sequences, holding periods, pick correlation with trending assets
AI Model / Process	Pattern-detection heuristics + supervised classifier trained on labelled behavioural archetypes
Outputs	A behavioural insight card (e.g., "You tend to chase last week's winners")
User Benefit	Self-awareness that improves real-world decision quality
Business Benefit	High shareability, strong differentiator for premium tier
Release Stage	Future Release

Risk-Awareness Feedback

Attribute	**Detail**
Purpose	Help users understand the risk profile of their simulated choices without recommending a different one.
Inputs	Portfolio concentration, volatility, sector exposure
AI Model / Process	Rules-based risk scoring + LLM explanation layer, strictly descriptive framing
Outputs	Risk score + plain-language explanation of what drives it
User Benefit	Learns to read risk, not just returns
Business Benefit	Central to the "education not advice" compliance posture
Release Stage	MVP

Adaptive Learning Roadmap

Attribute	**Detail**
Purpose	Sequence lessons and challenges dynamically based on the live competency vector.
Inputs	Learning profile, completion history, challenge outcomes
AI Model / Process	Adaptive sequencing algorithm (mastery-based, similar to spaced-repetition scheduling)
Outputs	A rolling, personalised curriculum queue
User Benefit	Always learning at the right level of difficulty
Business Benefit	Drives the Learning Progress KPI, the platform's North Star metric

Release Stage	Future Release (post-MVP)

Personalised Educational Content

Attribute	**Detail**
Purpose	Surface the right lesson format (video/article/interactive) and topic for each learner.
Inputs	Learning profile, engagement history, content performance metadata
AI Model / Process	Content recommendation model (collaborative + content-based hybrid)
Outputs	Ranked content feed
User Benefit	Less time searching, more time learning
Business Benefit	Improves session depth and completion rate
Release Stage	Future Release

AI-Generated Quizzes

Attribute	**Detail**
Purpose	Continuously expand the quiz bank without linear increases in content-team headcount.
Inputs	Lesson taxonomy, competency tags, prior question performance
AI Model / Process	LLM-based question generation with distractor design, human-in-the-loop review before activation
Outputs	Reviewed MCQ sets tagged to competencies
User Benefit	Fresh, well-calibrated assessments
Business Benefit	Scales content operations cost-efficiently
Release Stage	MVP (with mandatory human review)

AI Mentor / Chatbot

Attribute	**Detail**
Purpose	Answer financial-literacy questions and explain platform mechanics conversationally.

Inputs	User query, learning profile, conversation history
AI Model / Process	LLM with a hard system-level guardrail + output classifier blocking any specific buy/sell/hold language
Outputs	Conversational answer, with automatic redirection when a query strays into advisory territory
User Benefit	On-demand, judgement-free help
Business Benefit	Reduces Tier-0 support load; strongest compliance-risk surface, so most heavily audited feature
Release Stage	MVP (tightly scoped) → richer scope as Future Release

Market News Summarisation

Attribute	**Detail**
Purpose	Turn daily market news into short, jargon-explained digests tied to what the user is learning.
Inputs	Licensed news/market-data feed, user's current learning topics
AI Model / Process	LLM summarisation pipeline with source attribution and a strict no-recommendation filter
Outputs	2–3 line daily digest per relevant topic
User Benefit	Connects lessons to real-world context
Business Benefit	Daily-open driver; low marginal cost per user
Release Stage	Future Release

Financial Glossary Assistant

Attribute	**Detail**
Purpose	Instant plain-language definitions for financial jargon encountered anywhere in the app.
Inputs	Tapped/highlighted term, surrounding context
AI Model / Process	Retrieval-augmented generation over a curated, SME-verified glossary
Outputs	Inline definition card
User Benefit	Removes the single biggest onboarding friction — jargon

Business Benefit	Cheap to build, high engagement lift
Release Stage	MVP

Community Recommendations

Attribute	**Detail**
Purpose	Suggest leagues, communities, or friends aligned to a user's interests and skill level.
Inputs	Learning profile, existing connections, community activity data
AI Model / Process	Similarity-based recommender (collaborative filtering)
Outputs	Suggested leagues/communities to join
User Benefit	Finds "my people" faster, boosting stickiness
Business Benefit	Drives network effects and viral loops
Release Stage	Future Release

Achievement Recommendations

Attribute	**Detail**
Purpose	Show users the next attainable badge/milestone to pursue.
Inputs	Current progress state, badge catalogue, peer benchmarks
AI Model / Process	Rules engine with a "nearest achievable goal" heuristic
Outputs	"You're 2 lessons away from the Diversifier badge" prompts
User Benefit	Clear sense of progress
Business Benefit	Proven gamification lever for session frequency
Release Stage	MVP

Revenue Streams

Overview of the Business Model

Our platform operates on a freemium model, designed to maximize user growth at the top of the funnel while monetizing highly engaged users and institutions. The platform is free to join, allowing users to create private leagues, build virtual portfolios, and compete with friends without any entry fees or cash prizes.

We generate revenue through three main streams: a direct-to-consumer (B2C) subscription, business-to-business (B2B) corporate and university plans, and strategic ecosystem partnerships.

Revenue Streams

Stream 1: B2C Subscriptions (The Freemium Model)

The core of our platform is free. Free users can participate in basic daily and weekly leagues, view standard leaderboards, and access basic learning links. To monetize, we offer a "Premium Subscription" with clear added value.

Premium Subscription Features:

- **Advanced AI Insights:** Detailed, personalized breakdown of why a user's virtual portfolio won or lost, analyzing their risk levels and sector choices.
- **Exclusive Learning Content:** Access to premium masterclasses and trading guides.
- **Premium Leagues:** Entry into exclusive, high-profile leagues that feature better non-cash rewards (e.g., guaranteed internship interviews, 1-on-1 mentorship with experts).
- **Ad-Free Experience:** No display banners or sponsored content.

Pricing Structure:

- **Student Plan:** ₹99 per month (Requires valid college ID or email).
- **Standard Plan:** ₹199 per month.

Stream 2: B2B Partnerships (Tiered Rate Structure)

We offer a white-labeled or private group version of our platform to universities, corporate HR departments, and large student clubs. These organizations use our platform for employee engagement, financial wellness programs, or campus competitions.

B2B Tiered Annual Pricing:

Tier	Target Audience	Features	Annual Price
Tier 1: Starter	Small college clubs, startups (Up to 500 users)	5 Private Leagues, Basic Admin Dashboard	₹50,000

Tier 2: Growth	Mid-sized companies, regional colleges (501 to 2,000 users)	Unlimited Leagues, Custom Branding, Data Reports	₹1,50,000
Tier 3: Enterprise	Large corporations, top-tier universities (2,000+ users)	API Integration, Custom Masterclasses, Priority Support	₹3,00,000+

Stream 3: Ecosystem Partnerships (Affiliates & Sponsorships)

Because we are gathering an active, financially curious community, other financial companies will pay to reach our users.

- **Brokerage Lead Generation:** When free users feel confident enough to trade for real, we redirect them to partner brokerages (like Zerodha or Groww). We earn a flat commission (₹300 - ₹500) for every successful real-world account opened.
- **Sponsored Leagues:** Mutual funds or FinTech brands can sponsor specific free leagues (e.g., "The HDFC Challenge") for brand visibility, paying us a flat marketing fee.

Go-To-Market (GTM) Strategy

Our growth plan is divided into three practical phases, focusing on low-cost, organic growth before spending heavily on marketing.

Phase 1: Community Seeding (Months 0 - 6)

Goal: Reach 50,000 active users by focusing heavily on colleges.

- Campus Ambassador Program: Recruit students in Tier 1 and Tier 2 cities to host private leagues for their classmates.
- Social Sharing Loops: When users win a league, prompt them to share their "Performance Card" on WhatsApp or LinkedIn. This acts as free marketing.
- Targeting Student Clubs: Offer Tier 1 B2B packages at a massive discount (or free for the first year) to prominent college finance clubs to get large batches of users at once.

Phase 2: Building Authority & Partnerships (Months 7 - 18)

Goal: Reach 200,000 active users and push B2C subscriptions.

- Finfluencer Collaborations: Partner with YouTube and Instagram finance creators. Instead of just paying them for an ad, we will create custom leagues hosted by them. Their followers will download our app just to compete against their favorite creator.
- **Corporate Outreach:** Begin pitching the B2B Tier 2 packages to HR departments as a fun "Financial Wellness Friday" activity for employees.

Phase 3: Scaling & Ecosystem Integration (Months 19 - 36)

Goal: Reach 1,000,000+ active users and maximize affiliate revenue.

- **Mainstream Digital Marketing:** Start running paid ads on Instagram and Google, as we will now have enough data to know our exact customer acquisition cost.
- **Brokerage Integration:** Heavily push the lead-generation funnel, converting our top virtual players into real-world traders through our partner platforms.

Financial Projections (3-Year Outlook)

These projections are built on balanced, realistic assumptions for the Indian market. We assume a gradual increase in the percentage of free users upgrading to paid subscriptions, and a slow shift from mostly student users to a mix of students and working professionals.

Key Assumptions:

- **Free-to-Paid Conversion Rate:** 4% in Year 1, 5% in Year 2, and 7% in Year 3.
- **Subscriber Mix:** Year 1 is 70% Students (₹49) / 30% Standard (₹99). By Year 3, it balances to 50% / 50% as students graduate and more working professionals join.
- **Churn Rate:** Factored into the net active user count.

Year 1 Projections

Focus: Finding product-market fit and building a college base.

Metric	**Target / Output**
Total Active Users (Free + Paid)	50,000
Total Paid Subscribers (4% conversion)	2,000
B2C Subscription Revenue	₹30,96,000
B2B Revenue (Target: 15 clients)	₹15,00,000
Partnerships & Sponsorships	₹10,00,000
Total Year 1 Revenue	₹55,96,000 (~₹56 Lakhs)

Year 2 Projections

Focus: Influencer growth and pushing corporate B2B sales.

Metric	Target / Output
Total Active Users (Free + Paid)	200,000
Total Paid Subscribers (5% conversion)	10,000
B2C Subscription Revenue	₹1,66,80,000
B2B Revenue (Target: 60 clients)	₹75,00,000
Partnerships & Sponsorships	₹40,00,000
Total Year 2 Revenue	₹2,81,80,000 (~₹2.81 Crore)

Year 3 Projections

Focus: Mass scale, high conversion, and strong affiliate payouts.

Metric	Target / Output
Total Active Users (Free + Paid)	1,000,000
Total Paid Subscribers (7% conversion)	70,000
B2C Subscription Revenue	₹12,51,60,000
B2B Revenue (Target: 150 clients)	₹2,50,00,000
Partnerships & Affiliate Lead Gen	₹3,00,00,000
Total Year 3 Revenue	₹18,01,60,000 (~₹18.02 Crore)

Legal and Regulatory Compliance Assessment

Purpose and Scope

This assessment records the evolution of InvestIQ from its original concept into the revised product proposed for implementation. The initial model was conceived as a fantasy-style portfolio league in which users created virtual portfolios, competed using market-linked outcomes, participated through public or private leagues, and

could potentially receive monetary rewards. The revised model is an e-learning platform in which users subscribe for access to financial education, AI-assisted learning, behavioural finance content, portfolio simulations, quizzes and gamified learning challenges. Any vouchers, merchandise, certificates or complimentary subscriptions are intended as platform-funded or sponsor-funded promotional rewards and are not drawn from participant contributions.

Original Business Model

The original product combined real or near real-time stock-market data, virtual capital, fantasy-style leagues, leaderboards, portfolio rankings and possible entry-fee-based contests. Users would make simulated investment decisions and compete on the basis of actual market performance, while the platform expected to generate revenue through subscriptions, paid contests, partnerships and possible broker referrals. This description is consistent with the project's Progress Report, which identified the use of real market data, daily or weekly contests, leaderboards, AI-driven feedback and a multi-revenue model as core features of InvestIQ.

Revised Business Model

The finalised product does not operate as a stock-trading, brokerage or investment-advisory platform. It is designed as a subscription-based financial learning platform, with gamification used only as a teaching and engagement method. The subscription is consideration for educational content, AI coaching, assessments, simulations, analytics and related platform features; it is not an entry fee, stake or contribution to a prize pool. The revised model also removes participant-funded cash contests and does not promise monetary gain from market predictions.

Why the Original Model Was Redesigned

Live and Near Real-Time Market Data

The original model depended on recent market data to determine portfolio values, rankings and contest outcomes. SEBI Circular No. SEBI/HO/MRD/MRD-PoD-3/P/CIR/2024/56 dated 24 May 2024 created a specific framework for sharing real-time price data with third parties. SEBI subsequently modified the educational-use framework through Circular No. HO/47/17/12(11)2025-MRD-POD3/I/11107/2026 dated 8 May 2026, including the treatment of price data used for educational purposes. The regulatory issue was therefore not that all market data use is prohibited, but that the proposed commercial use involved recent exchange-linked data being used to operate gamified contests, rankings and engagement outside a conventional trading or regulated-market function.

Accordingly, the original product could not safely proceed merely by describing itself as educational while continuing to use live or near-live prices as the basis for competitions and rewards. Any future use of exchange

data would have to be assessed against the applicable SEBI circular, the relevant exchange or authorised vendor agreement, and the precise rights granted for display, redistribution, storage, derived calculations and contest settlement. The team therefore removed live-data dependency from the revised product rather than building the core user experience on an unresolved permission and licensing position.

Entry Fees, Stakes and Monetary Rewards

The original model also contemplated users paying entry fees and competing for cash rewards linked to virtual portfolio performance. Section 2(1)(g) of the Promotion and Regulation of Online Gaming Act, 2025 defines an online money game as an online game, whether based on skill, chance or both, played through payment of fees, deposit of money or other stakes with an expectation of monetary or other enrichment in return. Section 5 prohibits the offering of an online money game or online money gaming service, while Sections 6 and 7 prohibit related advertisements and fund transfers.

The concern was not the virtual portfolio by itself. The regulatory trigger arose from combining participant payment, market-linked competition and an expectation of financial reward. Section 2(1)(j) also defines other stakes to include credits, coins, tokens or similar objects that are equivalent or convertible to money and purchased in relation to an online game. The participant-funded prize-pool structure was therefore removed rather than preserved through different terminology.

Legal Basis for Taking Forward the Revised Model

Subscription for Educational Access

The revised model charges users for access to financial learning content, AI-assisted coaching, simulations, assessments, analytics and community learning features. Section 2(1)(i)(ii) of the Online Gaming Act expressly recognises that an online social game may allow access through a subscription fee or one-time access fee, provided that the payment is not in the nature of a stake or wager.[7] InvestIQ must therefore maintain a direct and demonstrable link between the subscription price and the educational services delivered, rather than tying payment to prize eligibility.

Gamification as a Learning Method

The revised product uses quizzes, portfolio exercises, leaderboards, badges and community challenges as learning tools. Section 2(1)(i)(iii) states that an online social game may be offered solely for entertainment, recreation or skill-development purposes, while Section 4 directs the Government to facilitate online social games for recreational and educational purposes. This supports the revised design only so long as learning and skill development remain the actual product purpose and the platform does not recreate a participant-funded money game through its reward mechanics.

Promotional Rewards without Participant Stakes

High-performing learners may receive vouchers, merchandise, certificates or complimentary subscriptions, but those rewards must be funded independently by InvestIQ or an identified sponsor. The platform should not pool subscription receipts, allocate a portion of user payments to rewards, or market the subscription as consideration for a chance to win. This separation is necessary because Section 2(1)(i)(i) excludes staking and participation with an expectation of monetary gain, while Section 2(1)(g) captures payment or stakes made in expectation of enrichment.

AI Restricted to Education and Explanation

The AI component may explain diversification, concentration risk, volatility, behavioural biases, portfolio construction and the consequences of simulated decisions. It should not provide personalised buy, sell or hold instructions, target prices or security-specific recommendations. Regulation 3 of the SEBI (Investment Advisers) Regulations, 2013 requires registration before acting as an investment adviser, and Regulation 3 of the SEBI (Research Analysts) Regulations, 2014 similarly requires registration before acting as a research analyst. The product must therefore retain output controls, restricted prompt categories and review mechanisms that keep the AI within an educational role.

Pre-Launch Compliance and Control Framework

The revised model is materially more defensible than the original participant-funded market-contest model, but compliance depends on implementation rather than description alone. The following controls must be completed before commercial launch and retained as continuing product-governance requirements.

Compliance Area	Required Control	Legal or Regulatory Basis
Subscription structure	Terms, pricing pages and invoices must state that payment is for educational content and platform access, and must not link subscription payment to entry into a reward pool.	PROG Act, 2025, Sections 2(1)(g) and 2(1)(i)(ii).
Reward governance	Vouchers, merchandise, certificates and subscription extensions must be platform-funded or sponsor-funded, recorded under a written reward policy, and kept separate from participant payments.	PROG Act, 2025, Sections 2(1)(g), 2(1)(i)(i) and 2(1)(j).

Market data	No live or delayed exchange data should be deployed until the data source, permitted purpose, display rights, storage rights, derived-use rights and redistribution rights are documented.	SEBI Circular 2024/56 and SEBI Circular dated 8 May 2026.
AI controls	The AI must block personalised security recommendations, buy/sell/hold calls and target prices, while retaining audit logs and approved educational response categories.	SEBI IA Regulations, Regulation 3; SEBI RA Regulations, Regulation 3.
Privacy and security	The product must provide user notices, capture valid consent where required, restrict processing to stated purposes, support deletion and withdrawal, and maintain security and incident-response controls.	Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023.
Product governance	Any change involving paid challenges, rewards, market data, AI outputs, broker referrals or monetisation must undergo documented legal and compliance review before release.	PROG Act, 2025, Section 8(2)(a) and Section 8(3).

Conclusion

The original InvestIQ model was redesigned because its dependence on recent exchange-linked data and participant-funded monetary contests created material regulatory exposure under the SEBI market-data framework and the Promotion and Regulation of Online Gaming Act, 2025. The revised model can be taken forward as a subscription-based financial e-learning platform, provided subscriptions remain consideration for educational services, gamification remains ancillary to learning, promotional rewards are independently funded, AI remains non-advisory, and privacy and product-governance controls are implemented before launch.

References

[1] InvestIQ BPP Progress Report 1, Group B2, original product description and revenue model.

[2] SEBI Circular No. SEBI/HO/MRD/MRD-PoD-3/P/CIR/2024/56, dated 24 May 2024, “Norms for Sharing of Real-Time Price Data to Third Parties.”

[3] SEBI Circular No. HO/47/17/12(11)2025-MRD-POD3/I/11107/2026, dated 8 May 2026, “Norms for Sharing and Usage of Price Data for Educational Purposes.”

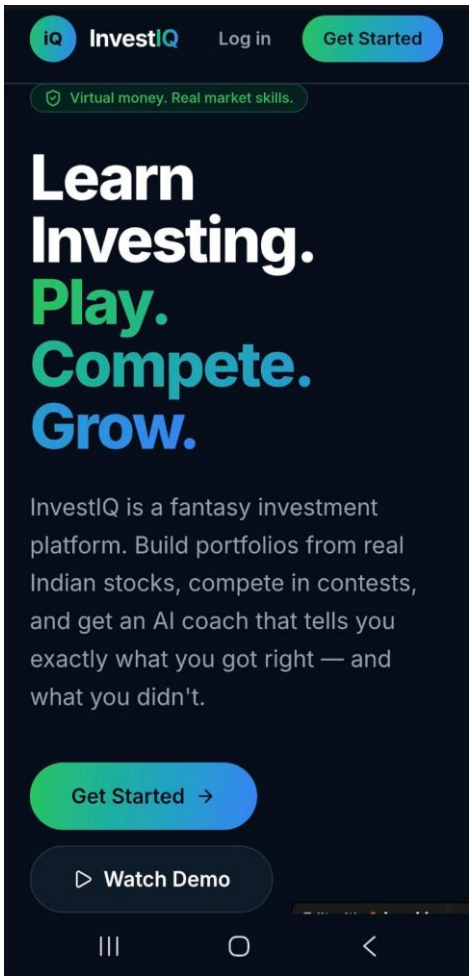
[4] Promotion and Regulation of Online Gaming Act, 2025: Sections 2(1)(g), 2(1)(i), 2(1)(j), 4, 5, 6, 7 and 8.

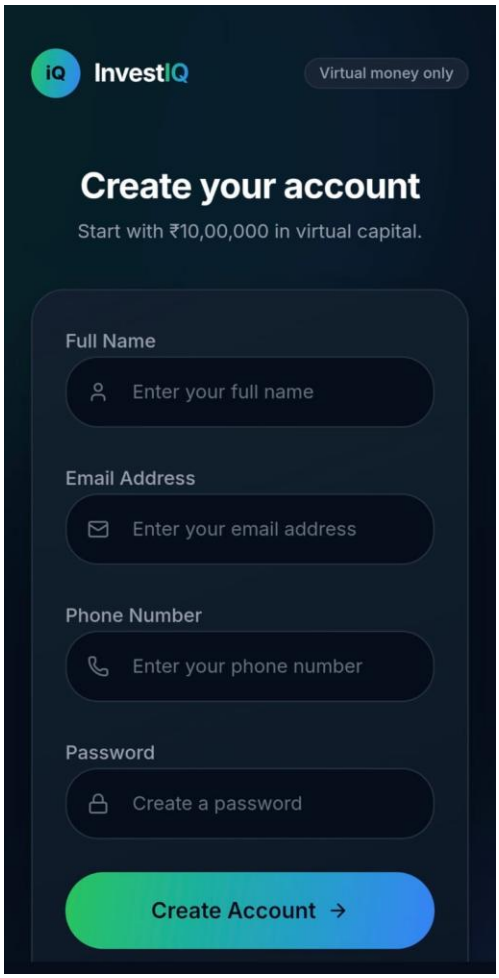
[5] SEBI (Investment Advisers) Regulations, 2013, Regulation 3; SEBI (Research Analysts) Regulations, 2014, Regulation 3.

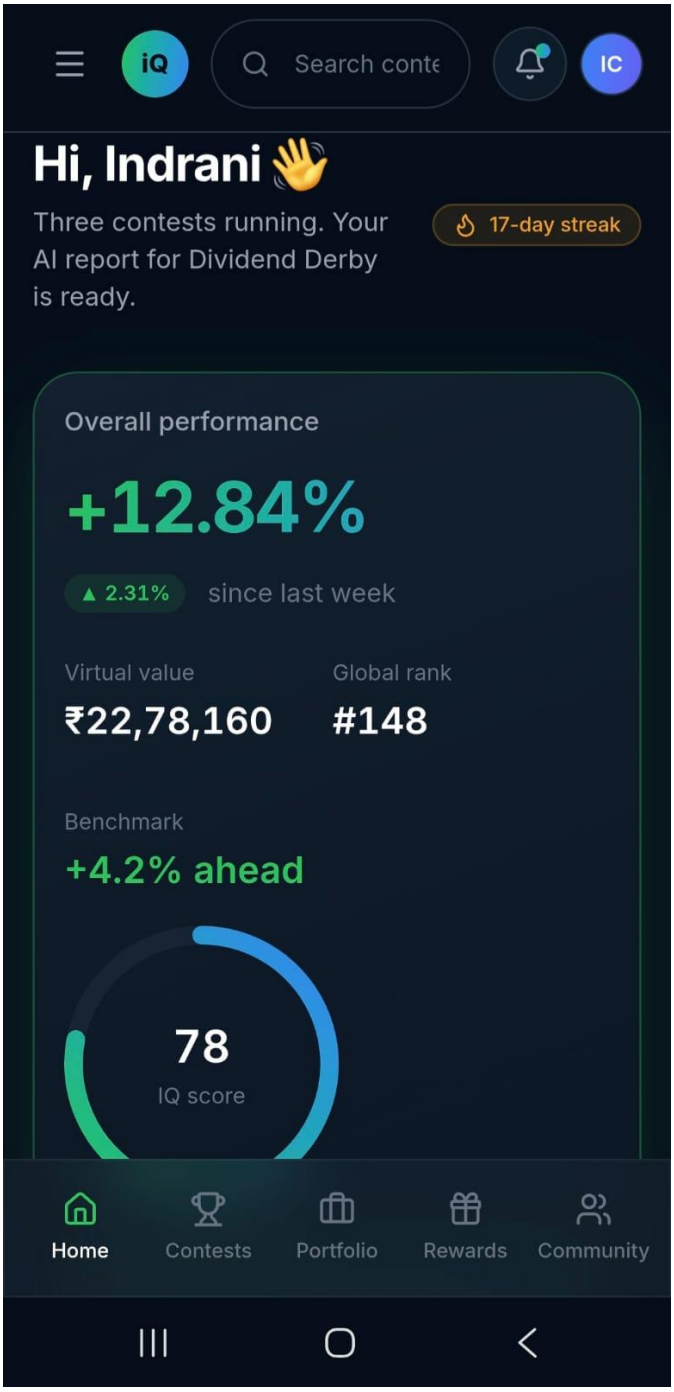
[6] Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023.

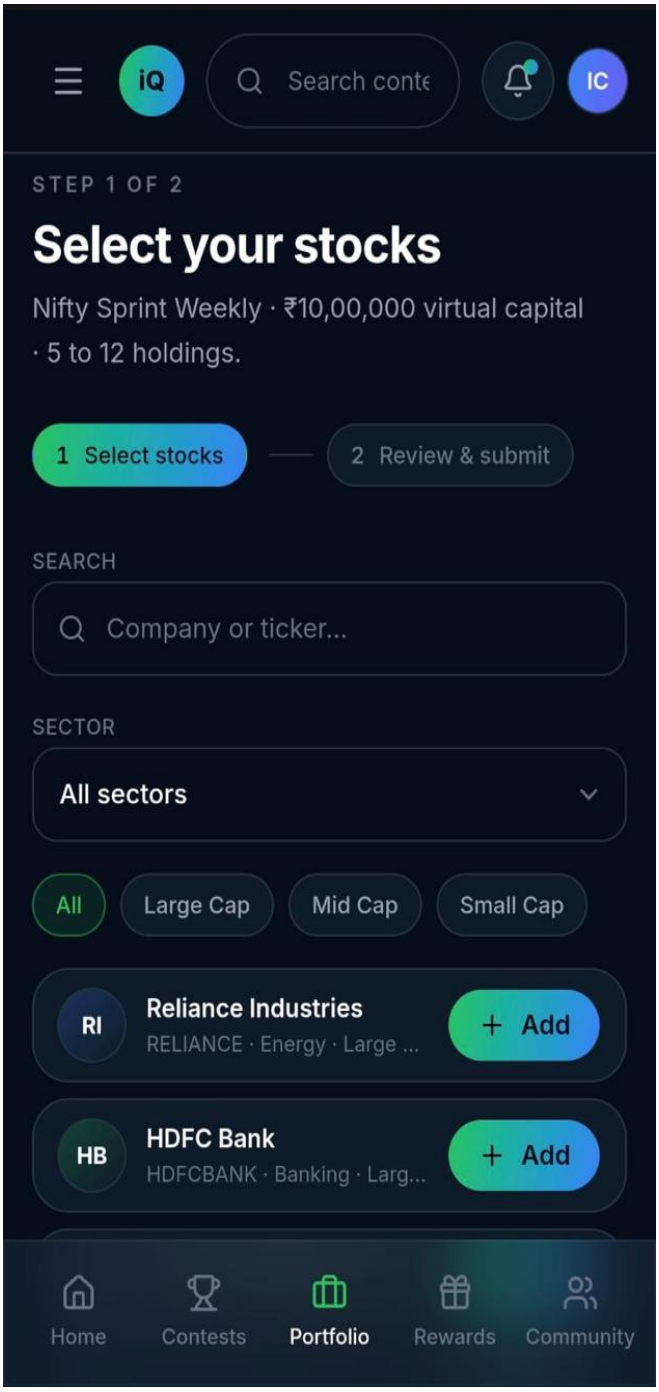
Appendix

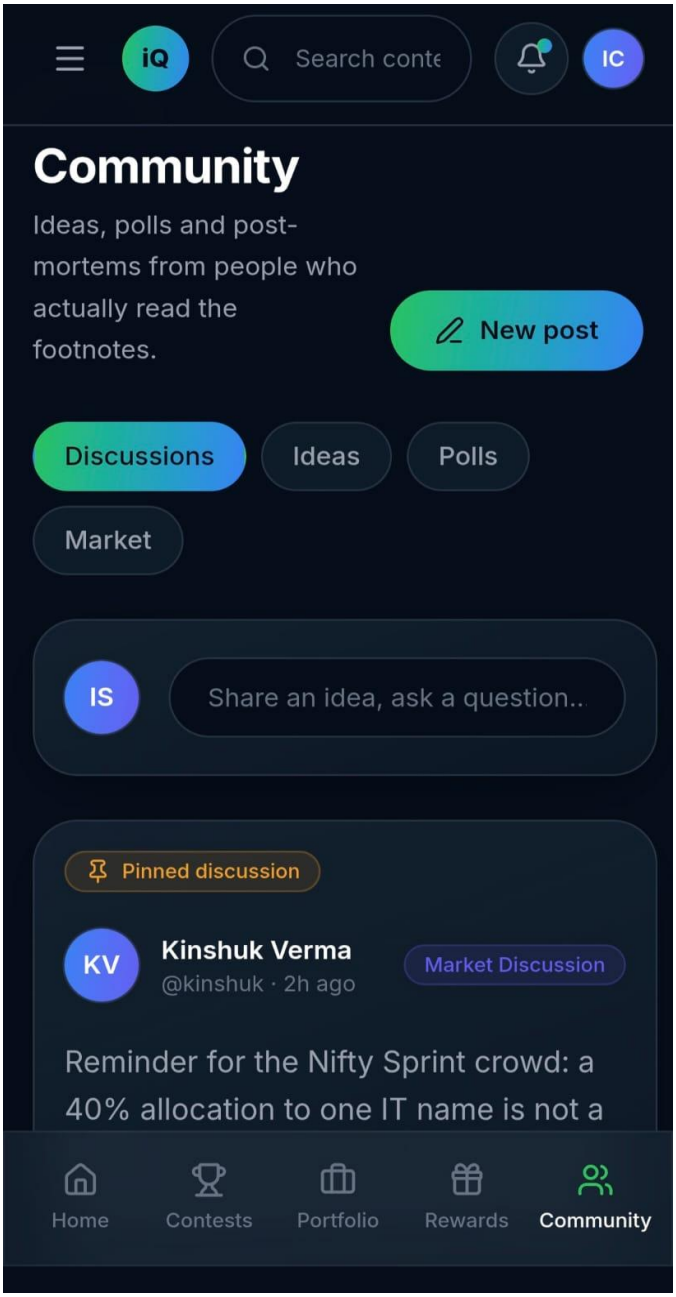
MVP Screenshots

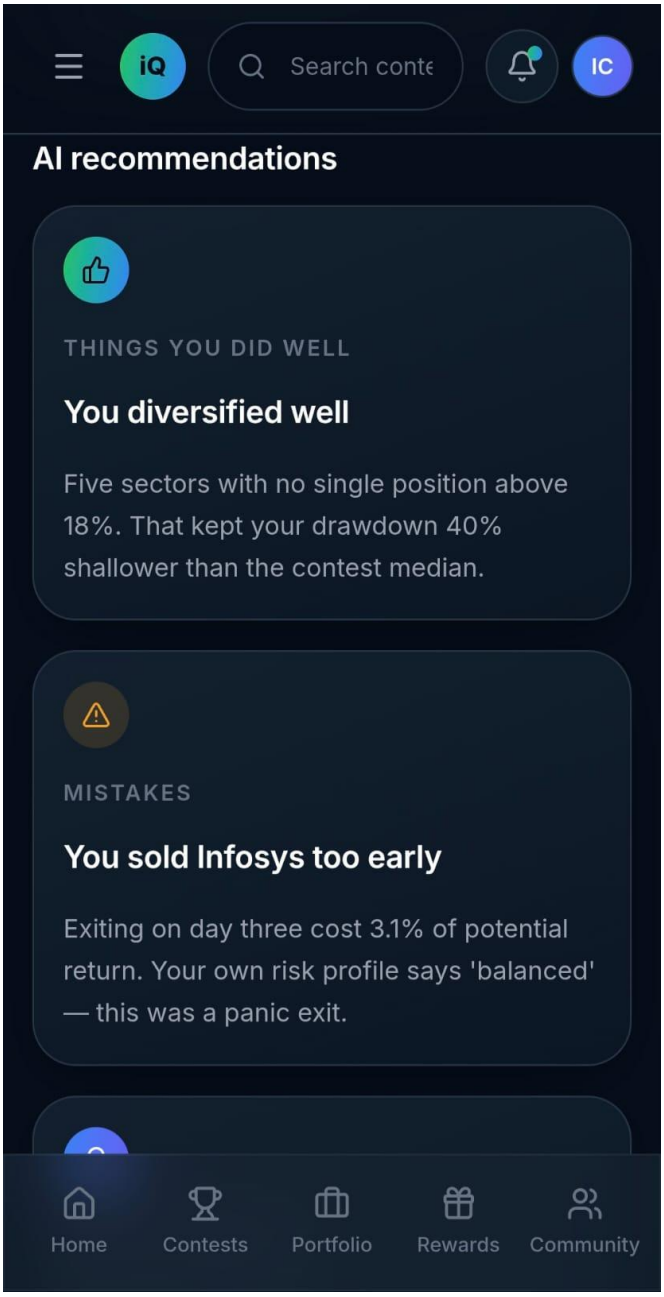


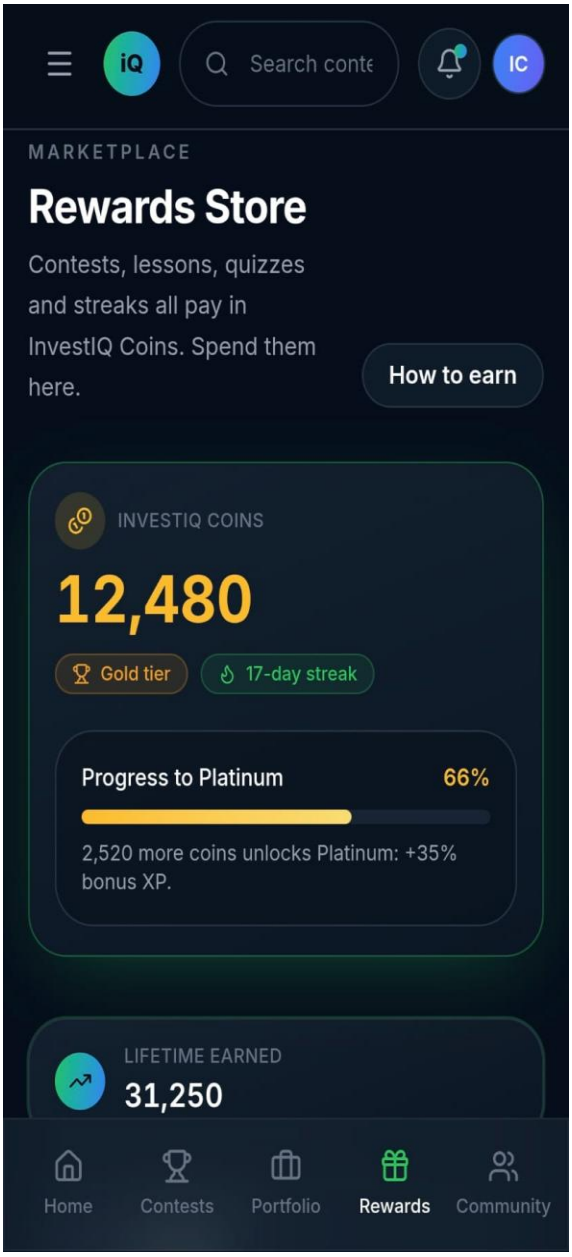


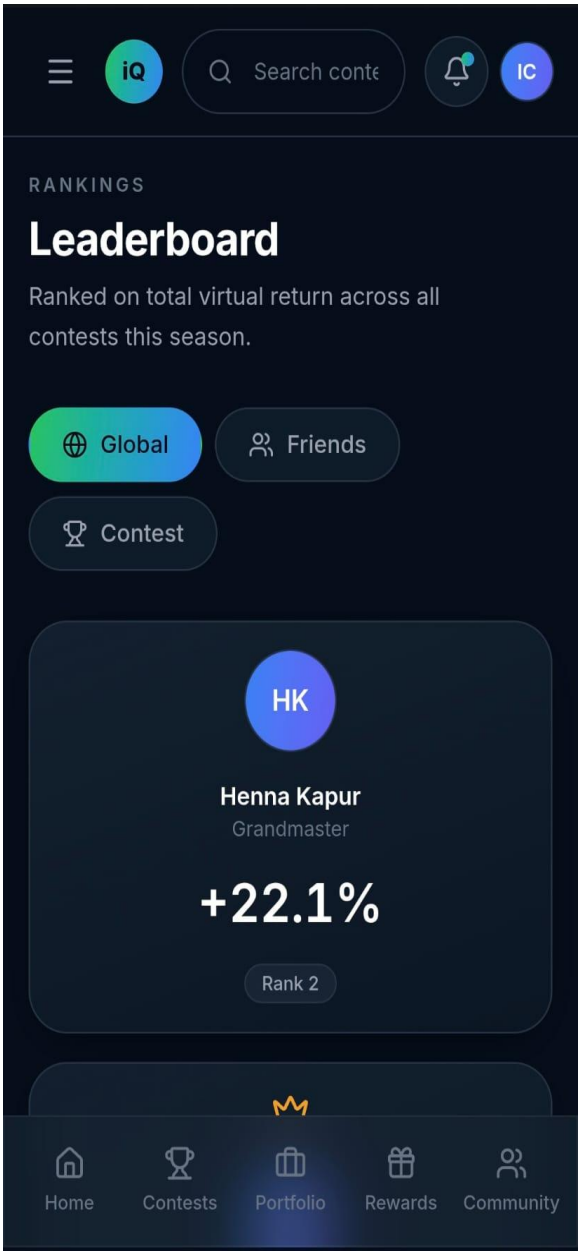

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Three contests running. Your AI report for Dividend Derby is ready.
17-day streak
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▲ 2.31%
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@kinshuk · 2h ago
Market Discussion
Reminder for the Nifty Sprint crowd: a 40% allocation to one IT name is not a
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THINGS YOU DID WELL
You diversified well
Five sectors with no single position above 18%. That kept your drawdown 40% shallower than the contest median.
MISTAKES
You sold Infosys too early
Exiting on day three cost 3.1% of potential return. Your own risk profile says 'balanced' — this was a panic exit.
Home
Contests
Portfolio
Rewards
Community





Member Contributions:

- **Agniva Sengupta:** Defining Product Vision, Roadmap and User Activation
- **Henna Kapur:** Competition Analysis and Market Research Analysis
- **Indrani Chakraborty:** Leading the Product Development and Industry Analysis
- **Kinshuk Verma:** Leading the Revenue, Growth and P&L Charter
- **Prakhar Tiwari:** Operations and AI-Integration
- **Rohit Badri:** Legal and Regulatory Compliance Assessment
- **Shubham Shree:** Product Design and Wireframes